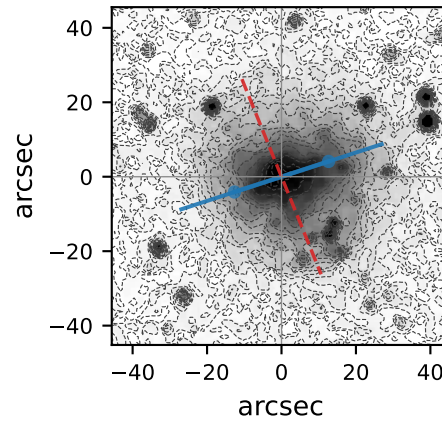
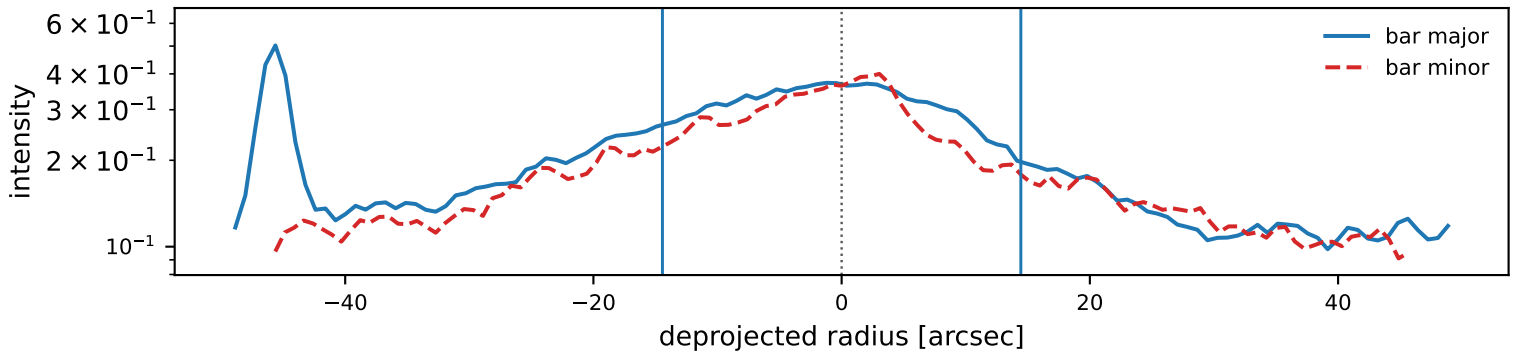


# ESO359-031 foreground-mask profile comparison bar PA=108.0 deg

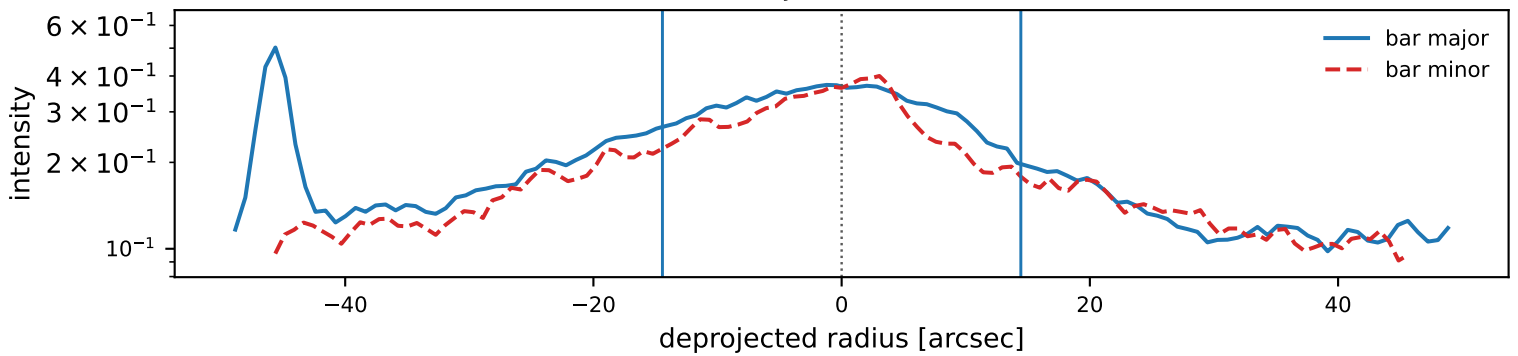
S4G 3.6 micron isophotes with masked objects circled



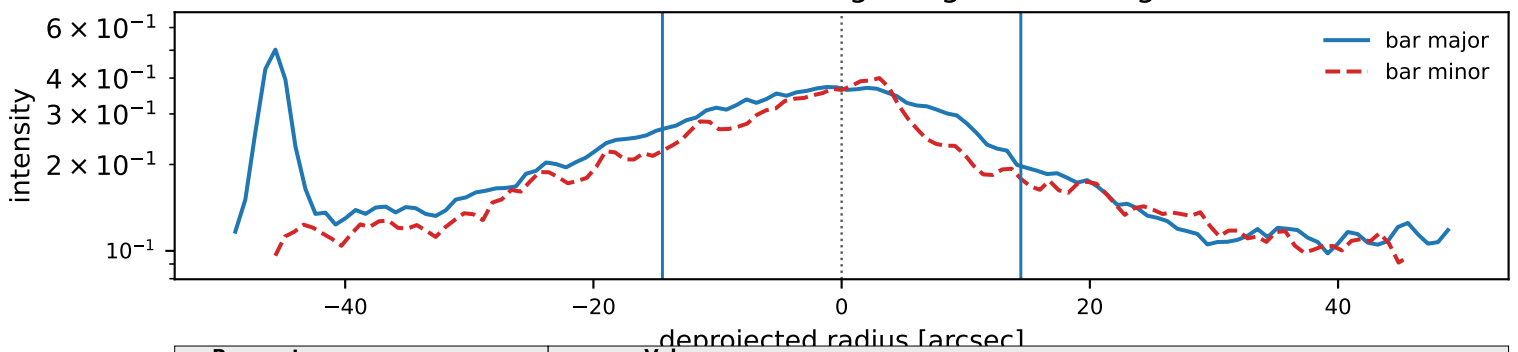
Original major/minor-axis cuts



Masked major/minor-axis cuts



Masked cuts with straight log-linear bridges



| Parameter                | Value                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Masking model            | spike-gated; photutils segmentation on residual image; photutils 3.0.0                                |
| Residual image           | science image - Gaussian-smoothed galaxy model                                                        |
| Detection threshold      | 5 sigma above residual median                                                                         |
| Profile spike gate       | 0 bar-major spike samples                                                                             |
| Spike rule               | peak $\geq 25\%$ above 4-15 arcsec neighbours; $\geq 40\%$ above $\pm 3$ samples; $ r  \geq 8$ arcsec |
| Smooth sigma             | 15 px                                                                                                 |
| Connected-pixel minimum  | 8 px                                                                                                  |
| Dilation radius          | 3 px                                                                                                  |
| Max segment area         | 500 px                                                                                                |
| Max elongation           | 6                                                                                                     |
| Central exclusion radius | 12 px                                                                                                 |
| Profile width            | 3 px                                                                                                  |
| Applied mask             | 0 source segments; 0 pixels ignored                                                                   |
| Filled-profile panel     | solid=measured data; fine dotted=samples filled by straight log-intensity bridge                      |
| Bridge merge gap         | 12 profile samples                                                                                    |
| Auto-tune grid           | 5 sigma; selected 5 sigma                                                                             |